

Parallel Seven

Balance Offense and Defense

Offense and defense are balancing forces, and leadership requires both.

Leadership Model: SHIFT

Put It into Play

Reflection Questions

Make time to reflect before you lead forward.

1. What opportunities are emerging, and what risks are increasing?

2. What are we ultimately trying to achieve, and what must we protect?

3. Is our current strategy still serving us as conditions and resources change?

Team Conversation Prompts

Use these questions to spark meaningful conversations with your team.

1. What has changed in our situation, and what game are we actually playing today?

2. Are our actions aligned with the outcome that matters most?

3. Do current conditions call for expansion and investment or consolidation and protection?

4. If we shift our approach, what remains the same and what does success look like now?

Manager Conversation Prompts

Use these questions during your next one-on-one or performance discussion.

1. What signals suggest I should reconsider the balance between growth and protection?

2. Where should I adjust resources or tactics while remaining committed to the mission?

3. How can I explain a strategic shift more clearly to my team?

Take Action

Which one or two of these actions would benefit my team and our performance most?

1. I will assess current conditions for emerging risks and new opportunities.

2. I will clarify the mission, the desired outcome, and what we must protect.

3. I will identify signals that indicate our current strategy may no longer fit.

4. I will adjust our approach to balance investment and growth with protection of resources.

5. I will explain the shift, reinforce what remains constant, and clarify what success looks like now.

